The man whose turnings influenced me most was George Snead in Suffolk: he was a fine furniture maker, but turned a lot. His work was very pure with a strong Scandinavian design influence. Some of his work was featured in SH Glenister's 1968 publication. My wife Liz and I visited George in his wonderful workshop in Suffolk.

A person who has probably had the most influence on the turning world in general is Dougie Hart; a name that most people will not be familiar with. It is through some of his A-list students that his influence has spread worldwide. His workshop was at Shinners Bridge in Devon where he employed Wendell Crang (what a wonderful name). Dougie was a colourful character who drove a hearse and often delivered Devon craftsmen's work to London. Dougie was always ready to help any aspiring turner; I visited him twice before turning became my full-time career. The first time Wendell was sticking 'Made in Scotland' labels on Iroko bowls. The style of labels they were using impressed me; without any second bidding he told me the source. The second time was around 1972 when I was close to going full time. I was bemoaning the fact that I couldn't afford to work in teak (*Tectona grandis*), which was much in vogue at the time. He promptly told me of a source in High Wycombe: he told me to buy shorts, which man to see and "tell him Dougie sent you". I dealt with this company for years after being pointed in their direction.

Dougie's legacy is rich and lives on through those who passed through his workshop: Richard and Simon Raffan, Cecil Jordan and Nick Agar, to mention just a few.

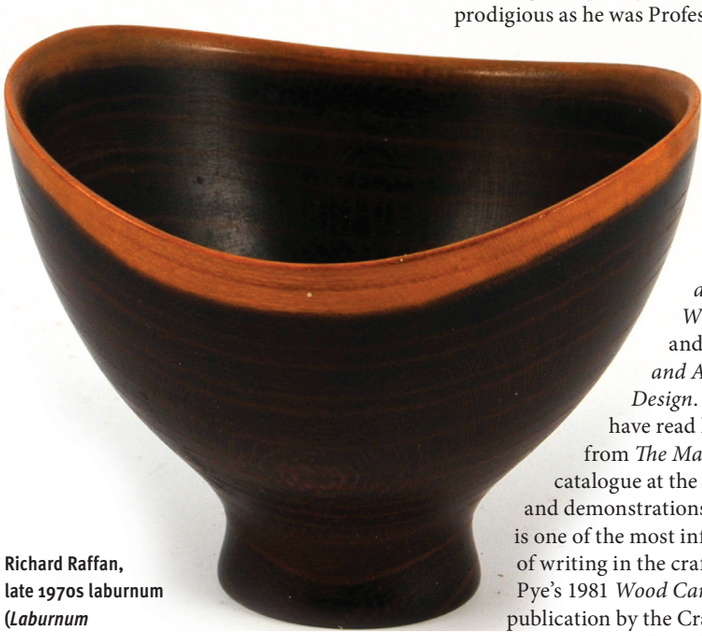
Richard Raffan is probably the best known turner in the world through his books, DVDs, seminars and workshops, to say nothing of his prodigious production for many years. Simon, who was also a potter, supplied the UK gallery market until he emigrated to Australia in 1982.

Dennis French, 1970s yew (*Taxus baccata*) sugar bowl and scoop

Cecil Jordan supplied the gallery market for years, right up until his death last year. He concentrated on ornamental turning in his latter years, producing mostly boxes. For many years he taught students at Parnham House in Dorset.

Nick Agar eventually took on Dougie's workshop and has in recent years become the UK's most creative turner. He is one of the most travelled turners in the world; he is sought out by organisations worldwide to lead workshops and demonstrate at seminars. He continues to produce imaginative and creative works.

David Pye greatly influenced me; he was very much a gallery turner, making boxes of the highest quality. His output was not prodigious as he was Professor of Furniture Design at the Royal College of Art. His writings still remain significant today: the aforementioned *The Nature and Art of Workmanship* and *The Nature and Aesthetics of Design*. For years I have read his telling essay from *The Maker's Eye* 1981 catalogue at the end of classes and demonstrations; to my mind it is one of the most influential pieces of writing in the craft world. David Pye's 1981 *Wood Carver and Turner* publication by the Crafts Council, in association with the Craft Study Centre, gives a wonderful insight into the range of his work philosophy and methods.



Richard Raffan, late 1970s laburnum (*Laburnum anagyroides*) bowl

The craft revival started mainly in the late 1960s and was in full swing by the 1970s. This was fuelled in the main by the public's reaction to the soulless mass production of items made from plastic and stainless steel, etc.

This was a good time to enter the craft world, when I gave up my day job in 1973 and we moved to Evesham, where Liz opened our shop. We were the fifth craft shop to open in the town and the last to close in 1985; all the others had gone in the early 1980s recession. Almost every Cotswold town and village had a craft shop through the 1970s; you can count them on one hand now.

In the 1970s, the Crafts Advisory Council (now the Crafts Council) was set up to promote contemporary craft. Galleries selling crafts came into being, which was almost unheard of previously. Henry Rothschild's Primavera gallery opened in 1946 and there wasn't much else other than the British Craft Centre (now Contemporary Applied Arts). Joan Crossly Holland's Oxford Gallery and the Peter Dingley Gallery came into being in the late 1960s. Both Joan and Peter were formidable advocates of the crafts; tough to deal with but encouraging. In my naivety I once called on Joan Crossly Holland unannounced and asked if she would be interested in looking at my work; I was firmly told that they only looked at work by appointment on Thursdays. However, not one to give up easily, I asked if she would look at some photographs. I received an unexpected and gratifying response: she said I should be on the Craft Council Index.

The Crafts Council Gallery in Haymarket, London, held some wonderful exhibitions while in that location. The independent galleries above championed mostly ceramics; turned wood was a peripheral craft and not a lot has changed today. Over time, my work was stocked by all of the galleries mentioned.

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